

Network-Based Diffusion Analysis

General Principles

The principle idea behind Network Based Diffusion analysis (NBDA) is that if social transmission is involved in the spread of a novel behavior through a group, then that spread is expected to follow a social network links Hasenjaeger, Leadbeater, and Hoppitt (2021). The basic model underlying NBDA states that at time t an individual, i , learns the behavior of interest with a specific rate formula.

In principle NBDA can be consider as a survival analysis, so we have the same concepts as in [chapter 12](#):

1. Where the **baseline hazard** (e.g. the hazard when all covariates are zero) is the asocial hazard.
2. Where the **covariate** is the sum of links toward informed individuals (i.e. individuals that acquired the behavior of interest at time $t - 1$).
3. Thus the **Hazard Function** which account for the network links weights **covariate** can thus be consider as the social rate of learning the behavior.

Considerations

Caution

- There are two main NBDA variants: order-of-acquisition diffusion analysis (ODA), which takes as data the order in which individuals acquired the target behaviour, and time-of-acquisition diffusion analysis (TADA), which uses the times of acquisition of the target behaviour.

Example

Below is an example code snippet demonstrating Bayesian Multiplex network model using the Bayesian Inference (BI) package Nightingale et al. (2015):

Python



R



Mathematical Details

Formulation

There are two parameters of interest in the basic time of acquisition diffusion analysis model: the rate of social transmission between individuals per unit of network connection, s , and the baseline rate of trait performance in the absence of social transmission, λ_0 .

$$\lambda_i(t) = \lambda_0(t)(1 - z_i(t)) \left[s \sum_{j=1}^N a_{ij} z_j(t_{-1}) + 1 \right]$$

Where:

- $\lambda_i(t)$ is the rate at which individuals i acquire the task solution at time t .
- $\lambda_0(t)$ is a baseline acquisition function determining the distribution of latencies to acquisition in the absence of social transmission (that is, through asocial learning). It can be specified by an exponential or Weibull distribution.
- $z_i(t)$ gives the status ($1 =$ informed, $0 =$ naïve) of individual i at time t .
- s is the regression coefficients capturing the effect of x on the hazard have an assigned a normal prior.
- $(1 - z_i(t))$ and $z_j(t_{-1})$ terms ensure that the task solution is only transmitted from informed to uninformed individuals:

$$z_j(t) = Y_i \sim \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } j \text{ is naïve} \\ 1, & \text{if } j \text{ is informed} \end{cases}$$

Notes

 Note

Reference(s)

- Hasenjager, Matthew J., Ellouise Leadbeater, and William Hoppitt. 2021. “Detecting and Quantifying Social Transmission Using Network-Based Diffusion Analysis.” *Journal of Animal Ecology* 90 (1): 8–26. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1365-2656.13307>.
- Nightingale, Glenna, Neeltje J Boogert, Kevin N Laland, and Will Hoppitt. 2015. “Quantifying Diffusion in Social Networks: A Bayesian Approach.” *Animal Social Networks*, 38–52.